Shivam Shukla

My research explores how people think, feel, and learn through computational artifacts.



Shivam Shukla

HI! I AM SHIVAM

I am a **Research Associate** at the Game User Interaction and Intelligence (GUII) Lab, led by **Prof. Magy Seif El-Nasr**. My research interests sit at the intersection of human-computer interaction, artificial intelligence (HCAI), psychological well-being and metacognition. I have a 4+ years of experience in mixed-methods research and product design.

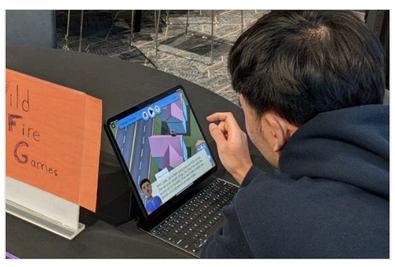
I am grateful for all the support I have received throughout my journey. If you would like to talk about research or are looking for any advice I can offer, feel free to schedule a chat with me here.

RESEARCH QUESTIONS I AM INTERESTED IN

- How Human-Centered design approaches could shape the future of space missions?
- How does AI enabled embodied and multimodal interactions shape mental health?
- What do patterns of social interaction in games reveal about player well-being?
- How metaphysics can help us to understand and evaluate the quality of human-AI experience?

Current Projects

RESEARCH FOCUS: META-COGNITION, MMOS & EMOTION REGULATION, HCAI, EMBODIED & MULTIMODAL INTERACTION



How Discourse in Serious Games Shapes Collaborative Learning and Wildfire Preparedness

This project explores how serious games can foster resilience, decision-making skills, and knowledge transfer in wildfire scenarios.

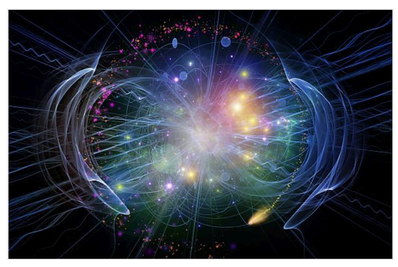
→ LEARN MORE



Psychological Well-being

Exploring psychological well-being in two directions: how MMOs like Sky address mental well-being and the role of embodied and multimodal interaction in mental health.

→ LEARN MORE



Reconceptualizing Human–AI Experience from a Metaphysical Perspective

We are using metaphysical theories to build a taxonomy of the human-AI experience.

→ COMING SOON

Selected Work

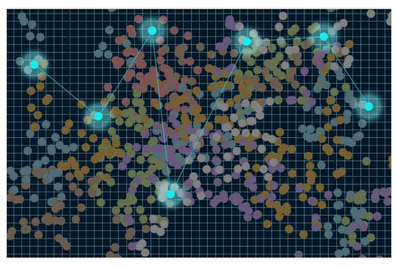
RESEARCH FOCUS: COMMUNITY RESEARCH, LEARNING, HUMAN-AI INTERACTION, DECISION-MAKING



Persona Driven Collaborative Storytelling (PDCS): Community Research

We detail the process of designing and implementing PDCS, present two case studies focused on Indian international students in the US, and evaluate the PDCS's effectiveness.

→ COMING SOON



Transfer Learning in an Educational Parallel Programming Game

I worked on the design evaluation of Parallel X, an NSF-funded educational game project aimed at improving how computer science students learn parallel programming and concurrency concepts.

→ COMING SOON



Playbook: Virtual Pilot for Space Mission Success

An AI system supporting contingency planning for mission planners and crew members, enhancing the existing scheduling tool Playbook by addressing key challenges in planning under constraints.

→ COMING SOON

Publications & Talks

Shukla, S., Chen, E., Roshanaei, M., & El-Nasr, M. S. (2026). Relationship-Centered Care: Relatedness and Responsible Design for Human Connections in Mental-Healthcare. *Workshop on Toward Relationship-Centered Care with AI.*

CHI 2026

Escarce Junior, M., Johns, M., **Shukla, S.,** Lee, D., & El-Nasr, M. S. (2026). Talking Wildfire: How Discourse in Serious Games Shapes Collaborative Learning and Preparedness. In *Foundations of Digital Games (FDG) Conference.*

FDG 2026

Escarce Junior, M., **Shukla, S.,** Lee, D., El-Nasr, M. S. et al. (2025). Fostering collaborative knowledge-building and resilience through player discourse in serious games for wildfire preparedness. *In Joint International Conference on Serious Games, pages 121–137. Springer.*

JCSG 2025

Annual Alameda County Community Meeting for NSF-funded Smart and Connected Community Project. (2025)

TALK

Future of Space Mission Success: AI Powered System for Contingency Planning. *NASA Ames Research Center, Human System Integration Division.* (2024)

TALK

My Research and Design Philosophy

I believe that technology should be built with people, not just for them. **Co-creation, critical thinking,** and **care** are the key components of my research and design process. I love questioning assumptions, centering lived experience, and making space for ambiguity and nuance, especially in spaces shaped by AI. Would love to discuss more about my work.

GET IN TOUCH

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Santa Clara, California, U.S.